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The Smart Home Buyer's Checklist

Run this before you add anything to a cart. Tick each box only when you have actually checked it.

- ☐ **My devices will connect to 2.4 GHz Wi-Fi.**
Many plugs, bulbs and cameras only join the 2.4 GHz band. My 2.4 GHz network name:

- ☐ **Plug and power fit the U.S.**
Type A/B plug and 120 V, or the device runs on batteries or USB. Devices with EU, UK or AU plugs are not a match.

- ☐ **I checked whether it needs a hub.**
Zigbee devices need a compatible hub or gateway, sold separately. Wi-Fi and Bluetooth devices do not.

- ☐ **The listing names the app and the assistants.**
Look for the app, plus Alexa and/or Google Assistant, written on the product page.

- ☐ **Wall-plug items show a UL or ETL mark.**
On the product or in the listing. If it is not there, ask before you buy.

- ☐ **Smoke, CO and gas alarms: UL-listed, established brands only.**
UL 217 for smoke, UL 2034 for carbon monoxide. These protect lives, so we do not sell them, on purpose.

- ☐ **I read the store's return policy.**
Know what happens if something arrives damaged or wrong before you pay.

- ☐ **My Wi-Fi reaches the exact spot.**
Stand where the device will live and test your signal on your phone.

TEST 1**Signal**

Run a speed test at the device's spot. Note the result.

TEST 2**Cost**

Add the hub, if any, to your total before you decide.

TEST 3**Start small**

Buy for one room first. Expand only after you use it.

Plan your kit, room by room

ROOM	DEVICE	WI-FI / ZIGBEE / BLUETOOTH	HUB?	PRICE
Living room				
Bedroom				
Kitchen				
Entryway				
Office				

My budget for the whole kit _____ Total _____

Your first week

One small step a day beats a weekend of frustration.

- ☐ **DAY 1**
Check your Wi-Fi
Test the signal where the device will go. Note your 2.4 GHz name.
- ☐ **DAY 2**
Install one device
Name it by room, like "Living Room Lamp".
- ☐ **DAY 3**
Link your assistant
Connect Alexa or Google Home and test a voice command.
- ☐ **DAY 4**
Your first routine
One simple schedule, such as lights on at sunset.
- ☐ **DAY 5**
Add a sensor
A door or motion sensor with one action.
- ☐ **DAY 6**
Share with the household
Invite the people you live with.
- ☐ **DAY 7**
Review, then expand
Keep what you used. Buy the next device only if you used the first.